

Will Cygan

wcygan.io@gmail.com | Chicago, IL
wcygan.net | github.com/wcygan | linkedin.com/in/wcygan
U.S. citizen · Authorized to work in the U.S. · No sponsorship required

PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 5 years of experience across backend, platform, infrastructure, and product engineering. Builds high-scale, resilient systems spanning APIs, relational databases, streaming, and batch processing. Delivers internal platforms and growth products tied to engagement and revenue.

EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn — *Senior Software Engineer*

Dates: Mar 2024 - Present · Location: Chicago, IL

- Designed and implemented a churn-recovery alerting platform from inception, generating \$2M in annual revenue; scaled serving to 100K QPS and streaming ingestion to ~500 writes/s.
- Over the next two years, led technical onboarding for 3 partner teams across usage billing, winback offers, and cancellation reminders, growing platform-attributed annual revenue from \$2M to \$8M.
- Led the zero-downtime migration of LinkedIn's 12 TB, 20B-row ordering database from Oracle to MySQL with zero data loss.
- Designed a reusable Oracle-to-MySQL migration framework adopted by 10 domain teams, using shadow reads, phased rollout, rollback, and TTL-based routing to preserve strong consistency.
- Introduced version-based optimistic locking across MySQL write paths, preventing silent conflicts caused by Temporal activity retries.
- Built a cross-system deletion pipeline that purged 300K corrupt orders, then extended it to target ~6B dormant rows, roughly 33% of a 10+ year-old database.
- Eliminated N+1 queries across all order-processing read paths, reducing average latency 40% (50 to 30 ms) and p95 latency 37% (200 to 125 ms).

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer*

Dates: Feb 2022 - Mar 2024 · Location: San Francisco, CA

- Scaled a feed recommendation service to 3,000 QPS on LinkedIn's 50M+ DAU feed, increasing weekly learners 2.5% across 3 experiments.
- Built Spark targeting pipelines processing ~50 TB across 20+ datasets per run, expanding personalized learning alerts from 10M to 22M members and lifting weekly learners 1.09%.
- Improved feed engagement 0.2% at hundreds of millions of daily impressions by filtering audio-only content from video course recommendations.

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: May 2021 - Aug 2021 · Location: Chicago, IL

Amazon — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: May 2020 - Aug 2020 · Location: Chicago, IL

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: Jan 2020 - Apr 2020 · Location: San Francisco, CA

PROJECTS

Anton — *Kubernetes Homelab*

Focus: Kubernetes, GitOps, Self-Hosting · Repository: github.com/wcygan/anton

- Operates a three-node bare-metal Kubernetes cluster using Talos Linux and Flux CD GitOps.
- Automates delivery of personal projects: CI builds and publishes Docker images and validates Kubernetes manifests, while Flux commits image updates to Git and deploys each release to the cluster.
- Hosts public applications on the cluster: nu-sync.net, food.nu-sync.net, kneadybynaturebakery.com, and cs2plant.nu-sync.net.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Chicago Graduation: 2021
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, SQL, Rust, TypeScript, Bash

Infrastructure: gRPC, Temporal, Kafka, Flink, Spark, Airflow, Trino, Kubernetes, Docker

Storage: MySQL, Oracle, SQLite, Redis, DragonflyDB, Couchbase, Venice, OpenSearch, HDFS, S3

AI Tooling: Harness Engineering, Evals, Agentic Coding, Agent Orchestration, Pi, Codex, Claude, Copilot